



Vantec AVOX-100 Jukebox

Storage, movies, music and more!

Vantec's AVOX-100 Jukebox is a nifty 2.5-inch hard drive enclosure: you need to add the hard disk. It can play movies and music and display photographs on a TV set, and also acts as a standalone backup device—you can copy files directly from other USB devices such as thumb drives and digital cameras without the need for a PC.

The case is powered by a power adapter; it can also run on standard AA batteries using the provided battery adapter. The device can work like any other external USB storage device (as in plug and play). A little switch lets you toggle between three modes: storage, TV, and USB host.

When connected to a TV, files can be accessed via an easy interface. In our test, the device easily played DivX and MP3 files. A slideshow of photographs worked great. Data backup from other USB devices works without a hitch.

For its versatility, we think the Vantec AVOX-100 is worth the Rs 5,000 price tag.



Photograph Sandeep Patil

Company **Apical Impex Pvt Ltd**
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Rating



Sony VGN-SZ18GP/C

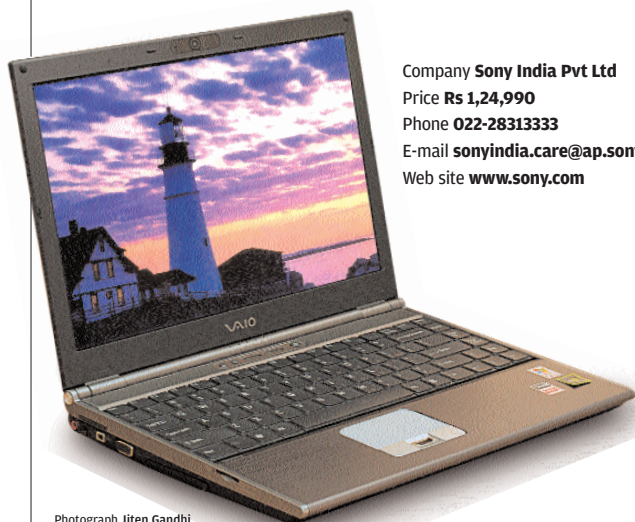
Razor-thin

It's a Sony, and it's powered by a Mobile Intel Core Duo processor running at 1.8 GHz. Other specs read 512 MB DDR2 RAM @ 533 MHz, an 80 GB hard drive, and a DVD-RW. The 13.3-inch wide-screen display supports 1280 x 800, and is one of the slimmest displays we've seen on any laptop we've ever tested! Image quality is crisp, colours are vivid, and the large viewing angles mean great visibility.

A new concept called the Hybrid Graphics System means you can change from Stamina mode—where an Intel GMA 950 graphics processor is used for low-power computing—to Speed mode, where an NVIDIA GeForce 7400 Go allows for high-powered gaming (at the expense of greater battery consumption).

Other features such as a Web camera integrated into the display, a memory card reader supporting almost every type of card, and Wi-Fi connectivity round up the features list. Rs 1,24,990 is, we think, a good price point for this notebook.

Rating



Company **Sony India Pvt Ltd**
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Photograph Jiten Gandhi

PENPOWER WorldCard Color

Digitise those cards!

For the busy marketing executive, the sudden availability of business card readers is a welcome development. PENPOWER's WorldCard Color is one such device that offers a no-frills approach to digitising business / visiting cards. It's bundled with seemingly intelligent software that recognises details from cards—company and person's name, address, phone number, e-mail ID and Web site. Scanning and extracting these details takes about 10 seconds per card.

The device installed without a hitch when we tested it on Windows XP. The software is intuitive, and bundles along features such as a *Mail To* the e-mail ID that was read, *Go To* the Web site, a powerful search feature, alphabetical sorting, and even the capability to read from an image file! With a resolution of 600 dpi, it can even be used a regular scanner for small (A6) documents such as ID cards, driver's licenses and so forth.

Company **Access**
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Rating



Photograph Anurag Patil